

Lesson Template/Requirements:

Lesson Title: Mapping My Memory

Grade Level: 10

Anticipated Duration of Lesson: (50 minutes)

Overview

This lesson takes place at the beginning of a descriptive writing unit designed to teach students the importance of writing and to show them that their communities and homes are important. This unit will help students become more comfortable with writing while showing them that their voice holds value. This unit will ideally take place at the beginning of the year, so their work can be displayed around the classroom for families to see at open house.

NYS Standard Alignment:

9-10W1f: Maintain a style and tone appropriate to the writing task.

9-10W3d: Use precise words and phrases, explicit details, and sensory language to convey a vivid picture of the experiences, events, setting, and/or characters.

9-10W3e: Provide a conclusion that follows from and reflects on what is experienced, observed, or resolved over the course of the narrative.

9-10SL1c: Pose and respond to questions that relate the discussion to broader themes or ideas; actively incorporate others into the discussions; and clarify, verify, or challenge ideas and conclusions.

Lesson Objectives/Instructional Outcomes:

Students will be able to write about a place that has meaning to me using descriptive language and discuss my work with a partner.

Today, I will be able to write about a place that has meaning to me using descriptive language and discuss my work with a partner.

Instructional Materials/Resources:

- Lesson PowerPoint  Mapping My Memory Slides
- Paper
- Pen or pencil
- Chromebook
- Lesson document  Mapping My Memory

The Plan in Action:

1. Introduction Anticipatory Set: (8 minutes)

At the beginning of class, we will go over the daily agenda, review the fun fact and SEL check-in, then go over the lesson objective. (3 minutes)

After this check-in, students will work on their warm-up that primes their minds for the upcoming lesson. The warm-up is a three-minute free-write where students will write about what the word “home” means to them. After they are finished writing, students will have an opportunity to share their responses with the class. (5 minutes)

2. Instructional Activities: (32-37 minutes)

Introduce the lesson by discussing how even the simplest places hold meaning and value. Tell them that they are going to write 1-2 paragraphs about a place that holds meaning to them.

1. Have students complete a mental walk-through of the space, noting and writing down specific details regarding how the place looks, sounds, smells, the memories or stories this place evokes, and its importance. (7 minutes)
2. After writing these down, students will begin their writing exercise with an opening sentence of its importance. Then, they will be instructed to use descriptive language based on the details they previously recorded. Students need to use at least two similes in their writing. (15-20 minutes)
3. Have students complete a partner-share with someone around them, sharing their ideas and asking for feedback (5 minutes)
4. After writing their first draft, students will be able to go through their writing and edit for grammar and descriptive language, replacing general words

with more descriptive ones. Digital thesauruses are great for this. (10 minutes)

3. Wrap-Up/Closure/Assessment (Formal or Informal): (5 minutes)

For the student's exit ticket, they will complete a "rose, thorn, and bud" reflection. For this, students will discuss what went well today (the rose), something that was difficult, frustrating, or confusing about this assignment (the thorn), and something that they're curious about or looking forward to regarding their writing.

This assignment allows students and the teacher to understand where they are with their writing.

Days 2-3 (ways to extend this lesson)

This lesson could be extended over multiple days by including a peer review of students' day-one work.

Students can pair up and, after reading their partner's work, make grammatical and technical writing suggestions in areas where they could be more descriptive.

After editing their work and taking their partner's suggestions into account, students will have the opportunity to add an image of the place they wrote about.

Another way to extend this lesson would be to have students create a theme song or playlist that relates to how this location makes them feel.

Differentiation According to Student Needs:

- Can be typed or written, with access to speech-to-text
- Provide sentence starters for those who need them
- Preferential seating
- Flexible seating
- Conferencing with students on their work
- Checking for understanding